

One organization, one story — how Co-Labr compares

Where Co-Labr sits next to the tools missionaries use today — Mailchimp and Epistle — and what changes when the *whole organization* tells its story on one platform.

Mailchimp is a general marketing tool that missionaries bend into a newsletter sender. **Epistle** is a genuinely good app built for the individual missionary. **Co-Labr starts from a different question:** what if every missionary and national staff member published from one branded home — where supporters discover the wider ministry, gifts route correctly through the organization, and leadership can actually see how their people are doing?

	MAILCHIMP	EPISTLE	CO-LABR
Built for	Businesses sending marketing email; missionaries adapt it.	The individual missionary — "by missionaries, for missionaries."	The whole organization. Every missionary and national staff member publishes on one platform, under the organization's own brand, with country-level co-branded pages.
ORG IMPACT One shared home instead of hundreds of disconnected accounts — supporters, staff, and leadership all meet in the same place.			
Writing an update	Generic campaign builder; every sender designs their own layout from marketing templates.	Quick social-style posts with photos and videos; posts bundle automatically into digest emails.	A guided ministry composer: banner, photos, video, key numbers, quotes, prayer & praise, giving, and a personal sign-off. Banner and sign-off are always present, with live preview, reusable templates, and simple text formatting.
ORG IMPACT Every update reads like ministry, not marketing — and the least design-gifted staff member still publishes something beautiful.			
Branding	Whatever each person builds; brand consistency depends on individual effort.	Epistle's own look and feel, with the missionary's content inside it.	The organization's real brand, enforced by design: block colors come from the organization's own brand palette, country pages carry national branding, and even the "most-read" highlight wears the brand color.
ORG IMPACT Hundreds of communicators, one visual identity — without a communications team policing every send.			
Supporter experience	One-size email blasts. The supporter's only lever is unsubscribe — and it's final.	Partners choose daily, weekly, or monthly digests and can like, pray, and comment from the email.	Every email carries a personal preferences link: full email, quick link, monthly summary, or site-only. New supporters get a warm welcome flow; anyone leaving is gently offered a lighter option first.
ORG IMPACT Fewer supporters lost at the exit door — people leave mailing lists, not relationships, and Co-Labr gives them somewhere softer to land.			
Discovering the wider ministry	None — each audience is a silo.	A partner follows their missionary; the wider organization stays invisible.	Cross-pollination is the point: a "team picks" rail on every wall, stories featured across pages with permission, the President's Monthly archive, and most-read rankings that surface the best storytelling.
ORG IMPACT A supporter who came for one family meets the whole movement — and prayer, awareness, and giving widen with them.			

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Giving	None built in — link out and hope.	Partners can give through the platform.	Giving routes through the organization: every page's Give button points to the organization's designated fund for that missionary's ministry — never to an individual.
	ORG IMPACT Gifts stay inside the organization's own designation, receipting, and accountability systems from day one.		
Member care	Open and click rates.	Engagement analytics — who opens, likes, prays, comments.	Care Radar: AI reads across everyone's updates for hard news, big changes, new babies, and losses; sends leadership a daily care digest; flags staff who've gone quiet for 60+ days; and tracks each person's trajectory across recent updates.
	ORG IMPACT Leadership learns who needs a phone call this week — from what staff actually wrote, not from open rates. No other tool in this space does this.		
Helping writers improve	Campaign stats: opens, clicks.	Detailed engagement reporting and an activity feed.	Coaching, not just counting: read-through insights, title studies drawn from real open data, most-read rankings, and AI writing insights for each page.
	ORG IMPACT The whole team's storytelling gets better over time — and great stories get seen and imitated.		
Adding your people	CSV imports and embedded signup forms; you manage the list mechanics yourself.	Invite partners; the app requests their communication preferences.	A shepherded migration: personal invite letters with one-click private links, CSV import with plain-language export instructions, and a "Your people" panel showing exactly who's following, who's deciding, and who declined.
	ORG IMPACT Moving hundreds of staff off old lists becomes a guided process each missionary can do alone in an afternoon.		
Data & GDPR	Supporter data lives inside Intuit's marketing ecosystem.	Strong security posture: encryption, private posts, invisible mode for sensitive contexts.	The organization's data, under its control: each organization's list is fully isolated from every other; supporters get one-click preference changes and full self-serve erasure; US storage is disclosed and covered by EU-approved safeguards.
	ORG IMPACT The organization can answer any supporter's GDPR question — or erasure request — in seconds, not committee meetings.		
Cost shape	Per-missionary subscriptions that grow with each contact list — typically \$20–100+/month each.	\$14/month per missionary (about \$168/year each; 300 staff ≈ \$50,000/year).	One organizational platform — a single relationship covering every staff member, instead of hundreds of individual subscriptions. (Organizational pricing to be defined.)
	ORG IMPACT Predictable, budgetable, org-level cost — and no staff member priced out of communicating well.		

Mailchimp and Epistle capabilities summarized from their public websites as of August 2026 (epistle.org, mailchimp.com); both are good tools, compared here fairly and in good faith — corrections welcome. Co-Labr is an app by Tov-ell LLC. This is a living document: add rows as features ship, and refine wording as we learn how to tell it.